

DISCRETE MATH

“INTRO TO GRAPH THEORY”

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Fundamentals

CHAPTER 1

Key Words: Define Algorithm and its complexity, Properties of an Algorithm, Binary Search Algorithm, Use Binary Search Algorithm, Insertion Sort Algorithm, Bubble Sort Algorithm

1.1. Algorithm

There are many general classes of problems that arise in discrete mathematics such as:

- given a sequence of integers, find the largest one
- given a set, list all its subsets
- given a set of integers, put them in increasing order
- given a network, find the shortest path between two vertices. When presented with such a problem
- etc

Definition 1.1 (Algorithm)

An *algorithm* is a finite sequence **precise** instruction for performing a computation or for solving a problem.

Note

Procedure that follows a sequence of steps that leads to the desired answer. Such a sequence of steps is called an **algorithm**

1.1.1. Algorithm for finding the maximum (largest) value in a finite sequence of integers

```
1 | // Find the largest Integer from given get of finite sequence.
2 | Procedure max(a1,a2,a3,...,an: Integer)
3 |   max = a1
4 |   for i in 2 to n:
5 |     if max < ai then max = ai
6 |
7 |   return max[max is the largest integer]
```

1.2. Properties of an Algorithm.

- *Input:* An Algorithm has an input value from a specified set.
- *Output:* From each set of input values an algorithm produces output values from a specified set. The output values are the solution to the problem

- *Definiteness*: The step of an Algorithm must be defined precisely.
- *Correctness*: An Algorithm should produce the correct output values for each set of input values.
- *Finiteness*: An algorithm should produce the desired output after a finite (but perhaps large) number of steps for any input in the set.
- *Effectiveness*: It must be possible to perform each step of an algorithm exactly and in a finite amount of time.
- *Generality*: The procedure should be applicable for all problems of the desired form, not just for a particular set of input values.

Note

To show that the algorithm is correct, we must show that when the algorithm terminates

1.3. Searching Algorithm.

- **Problem**: Locating an element in ordered list.
- **Example**: A program that checks the spelling of words searches for them in a dictionary
- **Name of this type of problem**: Searching problems.
- **General form of Searching Problems**: Locate an element x in a list of distinct elements $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ or determine that is not in the list.
- **Solution of Searching Problem**: The location of the term in the list that equal to x (that is, i is the solution if $x = a_i$) and 0 if the x is not in the list.

1.3.1. The Linear Search.

```

1 | Procedure: linear_search(x: Int, a1, a2, ..., an: distinct int)
2 |   i := 1
3 |   while ( i <= n and x = ai)
4 |     i = i+1;
5 |
6 |   if i <= n then location := i
7 |   else location = 0
8 |   return location( location of x is i if i or not found if i = 0 )

```

1.3.2. Binary Search Algorithm.

- Only applicable for ordered list with **increasing** order.
- **Example**: if the terms are numbers, they are listed from smallest to largest; if they are words, they are listed in lexicographic, or alphabetic, order)
- **Algorithm**:

```
1 | Procedure: binary search (x: int, a1,a2,...,an: increasing integer)
2 | i := 1 ( left endpoint of the search interval)
3 | j := n ( right endpoint of the search interval)
4 | while i < j
5 | | m := floor((i+j)/2)
6 | | if x > am then i := m + 1
7 | | else j := m
8 | if x=ai then location := i
9 | else location := 0
10 | return location [location is the subscript i of the term ai
11 | equal to x or 0 if x not found in list]
```